

VLAD'S CHRONICLES



Episode 4
**VLAD AND
THE ASGOIKYOS DILEMMA**
by T.T.Rider

Disclaimer

The novels of Vlad's Chronicles are an exclusive comedic journey tailored specifically for the delightful members of the

[Hopperverse](#)

If you stumbled upon these adventures by accident, be warned: Vlad's galaxy-hopping escapades, gummy-fueled rulers, and questionable fashion sense may seem more perplexing than trying to explain interstellar BBQ etiquette to aliens.

Non-club members risk bouts of laughter-induced confusion, mild existential crises, or sudden cravings for Ukrainian gorilka.

Read responsibly, and remember—without [Coffee with Christopher](#) context, Vlad's misadventures make about as much sense as a fanny pack in space.

This novel is a wild ride of fiction!

Any names you stumble across, especially those that sound like they belong to [Hopperverse](#) members or die-hard [Coffee with Christopher](#) fans, as well as the characters, places, and shenanigans within, are purely figments of the author's imagination—trust me, it's a pretty bizarre place!

If you happen to see any resemblance to actual events or real people

(photos included!), it's entirely by accident—not a conspiracy!
Seriously, just dive into this chaotic world, have a blast, and keep in
mind that the author is just here to sprinkle a little ridiculous fun
into our otherwise serious lives.

Enjoy the laugh riot!

Vlad's Chronicles

by T.T.Rider

Episode 4

Vlad
and
the Asgoikyos Dilemma

Previously in Vlad's Chronicles

Vlad, war hero, hopeless romantic, and proud owner of a tragically stylish fanny pack, has spent years hurtling across the galaxy in search of his long-lost love, Nikki from Vegas. Along the way, he crash-landed on a toe-sacrificing island cult led by gummy-addicted Big G-Nubz, earned the trust (and moonshine) of BBQ-obsessed Troy King, and accidentally played cosmic wingman for his sidekick Christopher—who married a literal Siren hours after meeting her. Still Nikki-less but now armed with magic gummies, a ship full of innuendo, and a growing legend, Vlad sets his course once more into the absurd unknown.

On the small, rocky planet some insisted on calling a paradise, Vlad—once celebrated as a war hero and, more importantly, the beloved post-war savior of the G-Nubz colony—found himself trapped in a role he never wanted. By pure accident and entirely against his will, he had become one of the prominent people in this G-Nubz-ruled utopia. All Vlad had ever truly wanted was to find his long-lost love—the showgirl who had set his heart ablaze during a few unforgettable, fiery weeks in Las Vegas, back in a galaxy that no longer existed. Her name was Nikki. Along with Celine Dion’s music, she remained one of Vlad’s most cherished memories, two bright sparks of joy he had clung to all these years.

But Earth was gone. Las Vegas was just a memory. Celine Dion’s voice no longer echoed among the stars, and Nikki... Nikki had disappeared without a trace. Desperate to find her, Vlad traveled from planet to planet, world to world, chasing rumors and whispers. Many claimed to have seen her—Vegas Nikki, they called her now—but she always seemed to vanish before he arrived, leaving behind only stories and faint impressions.

Still, Vlad refused to give up on the woman who haunted his heart. Yet even in his relentless search for Nikki, he wasn’t blind to the realities around him. A practical man at his core, he didn’t let himself be consumed entirely by that one dream. His heart was vast enough, open enough, to embrace other beautiful and fleeting adventures along the way.

This bright morning, Vlad was up earlier than usual and looking noticeably overdressed—two dead giveaways that he was gearing up for another adventure. Most days, Vlad preferred to sleep

in, and like the rest of the village folk, he didn't bother much with clothing. His tiny Speedo was typically all he needed. But today? Today, he looked every bit the warrior he truly was. Sporting his faded t-shirt emblazoned with a Ukrainian trident, an American flag Fanny Pack slung around his waist, and his trusty gun at his side, there was no mistaking it—Vlad was ready for action.

With determination in his step, Vlad made his way to the hut where Lynn resided. Not just the village Librarian, she also wore the hats of Peacekeeper and Trusted Advisor to the G-Nubz themselves.

Lynn was perched outside, lost in a deep reverie. What exactly occupied her mind was anyone's guess—it was impossible to pin down—but one thing was obvious: her expression carried a faint shadow of sadness.

That changed the moment she caught sight of Vlad approaching. A flicker of delight lit up her eyes. Ridiculing Vlad had always been one of Lynn's favorite pastimes, and today seemed as good a day for it as any other.

Standing before Lynn, Vlad didn't bother with pleasantries. "Hey, Lynn, may I have you for 5 minutes?"

"Just five?" Lynn replied with a mocking voice, "I didn't know you were such a fast shooter!"

Vlad winced, "Stop twisting my words! Do you have five minutes for me or not?"

"It all depends on what you have in mind. I'm not fond of quickies, so you know."

Vlad was starting to get annoyed, so he blurted out, "Quit wagging your tongue!" throwing in an old Russian saying for

meaningless chatter. But Vlad's remark only fueled Lynn's playful streak. She shot back with even more gusto, "Oh, you've seen nothing yet! I'm practically legendary for my tongue-wagging!" She followed up with an exaggeratedly suggestive gesture involving her fingers and tongue. "What about you—got any tales worth boasting about?"

Vlad, clearly nearing the end of his rope, snapped, "Can you just shut up for a second?"

Lynn answered in an overly serene tone, "Sure." After a brief pause—barely long enough to count—she added with a grin, "There. Silence achieved. Now, what's on your mind?"

Vlad let out a sigh of relief, hoping the banter was finally over so they could get down to business. If only he knew better...

"Lynn," he said firmly, "I need you to come with me."

"Cum with you?" Lynn echoed in a tone dripping with faux innocence. "Like... at the same time? You know, like in those steamy romance novels Christopher keeps hyping up?" She paused, a mischievous glint in her eyes. "I've got to admit, it's a tempting offer. But before I say yes, there's one thing I need to know." She paused for effect, letting the suspense build. "How's your tongue-wagging technique? I'd rather be prepared for what I'm getting into."

Vlad let out a low growl, more of a frustrated "Grrrr" than anything coherent, but he quickly composed himself, choosing to ignore Lynn's last remark. "I. Want. You. To. Come. With. Me. On A Trip," he said, emphasizing each word as if he were teaching her the alphabet.

Lynn, however, was unstoppable as ever. “Ohhh, my mistake,” she teased with a playful wink. “So, you wanna go ‘tripping’ first!” Her grin turned downright wicked as she tacked on, “And then some tongue-wagging? Gotta say, could be worse ways to spend the day!”

Vlad didn’t say anything. He decided that the best way would be to wait until Lynn is ready to talk business. After 10 seconds of silence, she said, “So, you want me to get on your rocket ship.”

“Yeah, my ship,” Vlad replied flatly.

“Is it... big enough?” Lynn’s tone seemed innocent enough, but Vlad could already sense he was stepping straight into her latest setup.

“It’s big enough,” he said cautiously. “Three or four people can ride it comfortably.”

And just like that, she pounced. “Three or four people? Riding your... rocket? All at once? Wow, now that’s something!” she said with mock amazement. Her grin grew even wider as she added, “Madam always hinted you were into doubling the fun, but three or four? That’s downright legendary, Vlad!”

Vlad figured the smartest move right now was to keep his mouth shut. He just folded his arms across his chest and stared down at Lynn, unflinching.

Eventually, she let out a sigh of defeat and asked, “And why exactly would I wanna tag along on your ridiculous little crusade?”

Vlad lit up, practically buzzing with excitement. “I found it! Well, technically, Stargazer Bill found it, but still! There’s a planet not too far from here—just a few hours away. When I hooked into their

Hypernet, my Hyperspace Tinder went nuts with matches! They call themselves New Vegas! Vegas, Lynn! Do you get what that means? Vegas!" He paused to catch his breath before adding, "You've been looking kinda down lately, so I figured you could use a serious shake-up."

Lynn couldn't resist seizing the moment, her grin turning wicked as she jumped in with fresh teasing energy. "Ohhh, so this is it! You and me, off on some interstellar... uh... *dick-hunting* adventure?"

"You. Not me," Vlad shot back flatly.

"Oh, come on," she said, waving him off with mock indignation. "Let's be real—ever since Christopher shacked up with Jennifer and started ghosting you, *you're* the one who's been looking all mopey."

"That's ridiculous! I see him all the time!" Vlad snapped, raising a hand like he could physically shut her up. "Enough of this nonsense. Go grab your stuff and meet me at my ship in twenty minutes. Don't make me wait!"

With that final command, he turned on his heels and strode away briskly, almost breaking into a run. Lynn watched him retreat with a smirk tugging at her lips. But as he disappeared from view, that smirk softened into something sadder—a smile tinged with regret.

Lynn had every reason to feel down today. Nobody in the village knew it, but it was her birthday, and she wasn't quite sure how to deal with that little fact.

Back when people from Earth were yanked away by plushies and unceremoniously dumped on this strange planet—lost, starving, and completely naked—Lynn had stepped up. She'd been one of the folks who helped organize the colony, working alongside G-Nubz as his right-hand woman. Once they'd tackled the basics like food and shelter, curiosity about their new world began bubbling up among the settlers.

One of those settlers was Stargazer Bill.

Bill looked like someone who had long ago made peace with the mysteries of the universe. Now that Vlad had established supply lines to bring in all necessities—and some completely unnecessary things, like clothes—Bill usually dressed in a black T-shirt, a black cap emblazoned with a red symbol shaped like a stylized “A,” dark sunglasses that mirrored the universe around him, and a relaxed smile framed by a neatly trimmed white goatee. Around his neck hung a red, white, and blue ribbon—he always wore it, though no one quite remembered why.

Despite his laid-back appearance, Bill was the kind of man who could explain black hole thermodynamics using nothing more than a coffee mug and a napkin. He spoke in a slow, even tone, like he was narrating the cosmos itself, and no matter how dire the situation, he never seemed rattled. Legend had it that back on Earth, he could name every single star with ease. But here, in this unfamiliar galaxy,

his celestial knowledge meant nothing—he was starting from scratch.

One day, Bill gathered everyone together in the Bonfire Square, a big circular place with a fire pit at the center where colonists gather for all-hands-meetings. Bill commandeered the dias, usually occupied by G-Nubz, and announced in his stady voice.

“This place we’re living in? It’s wild,” he began, gesturing vaguely toward the sky as if the planet’s orbit were painted up there. “See, our days here are about 22 hours—so if you’re feeling a little jet-lagged all the time, congratulations, your circadian rhythm is obsolete.”

He scribbled a wobbly ellipse on the ground in front of him, even that only a few people at front can see it. “Now, our planet’s orbit around this sun—Let’s call it Sun-2 or whatever—has a longer semi-major axis than Earth’s. That means our year is stretched out by about 30 extra days. Blame Kepler. His Second Law says we sweep out equal areas in equal times, but out here, the areas are just... extra area-y.”

Lynn blinked. “So what does that mean for us?”

“It means we need a whole new calendar,” Bill said. “New months, new holidays, possibly a celebration of Perihelion Day, when pass the closest point to our sun at around what used to be March, but now might be... Glibruary. I’m still workshopping the names.” Bill smiled.

The idea of adding a new month was intriguing, but the name and timing Bill proposed sparked plenty of debate. After some quick back-and-forth among the colonists, they agreed to insert an extra

month between August and September. The reason? To extend the summer. As for the name? G-Nubz Month. The logic seemed straightforward—July and August were already named after influential leaders from history, so why not continue the tradition? Naming it after another respected Wise Leader, someone everyone admired, felt like an obvious choice. Besides, a little brown-nosing couldn't hurt, they figured.

So, the decision was made: they'd add a new month to the calendar, but still celebrate holidays and birthdays on the same dates as before. Turns out, by sheer coincidence, the total hours in a year here lined up pretty closely with what they had back on Earth—or at least that's what Bill said, and no one really saw any reason to question him.

Lynn strolled onto the beach where Vlad typically docked his spaceship, fashionably late, twenty minutes behind schedule. Vlad was pacing restlessly near the ramp, his frustration growing with every passing second.

When he spotted her, he let out a relieved exclamation, "We were supposed to leave twenty minutes ago! We're on a tight schedule!"

"What's the rush?" Lynn asked casually, her tone dripping with indifference.

"There's no rush! Just get on already!"

"That's good," she replied with a sly grin. "Rush can be annoying. Especially in the wonderfully charming places of your body."

Vlad didn't say a word. He seized Lynn's arm and practically hauled her onboard. The moment the ramp sealed shut behind them, he darted to the cockpit, and the ship shot up into the sky. Barely ten minutes later, they jumped to hyperspace, speeding toward the enchanting planet.

Lynn blinked in surprise when she spotted Stargazer Bill sitting in the galley. "Oh, hey, Bill."

"Hey, Lynn. How's life treating you today?" he answered in his usual laid-back tone.

Right on cue, Vlad strolled into the room. Lynn shot him a pointed look and quipped, "Don't even tell me you're playing matchmaker with me and Bill now." She shook her head with exaggerated flair. "Awful plan. Like, epically bad. Lisa would kill us all if she finds out."

Vlad stayed composed, clearly doing his best to sidestep another suggestive comment. “Nope, nothing like that,” he assured her. “Bill here actually discovered that nearby planet—the little beauty we’re heading toward. He asked to come along so he could see it for himself.”

Bill offered a small smile, radiating that rare ability of his—to make complex things sound simple enough that even Vlad could follow without effort. His soft-spoken voice carried an almost hypnotic quality, the kind that made people want to hang onto every word, whether he was describing distant galaxies or spinning tales about driving a hearse.

“The planet we’re heading to is... something special,” Bill said, his eyes sparkling like someone who’d just uncovered a loophole in the universe. “It’s barely bigger than what our Moon used to be—about 1.3 lunar units, more or less. And yet, it has Earth-like gravity and a breathable atmosphere. Honestly, that shouldn’t be possible unless it’s secretly trying out for the role of a neutron star.”

Bill absentmindedly traced a circle on the slightly dusty table with his finger. “The only explanation? Density. Ridiculous, over-the-top density. Spectroanalysis confirms it: the planet is about 99% pure gold. Au. The real deal. There’s a bit of lead and uranium mixed in, but essentially, it’s Fort Knox with its own weather system.”

Lynn leaned in, her brow furrowed. “Wait, gold? Like, actual gold?”

“Exactly,” Bill replied with a calm nod. “You know how sci-fi loves planets made of diamonds? That’s amateur hour. This planet is

a Midas fever dream. I used that high-res telescope Vlad 'liberated' from the Undaspzilopian flea market and saw active volcanoes spewing liquid gold. Rivers of it. Molten, shimmering streams of pure bling."

He paused for effect, casually adjusting his sunglasses with one finger.

"In short," he added, completely straight-faced, "the locals are probably dealing with golden showers on a geological scale. Maybe even daily."

Lynn wasn't about to let that one slide. "Well," she said with a sly grin, "I know some people are into kinky stuff, but 'golden showers' have never exactly been my thing." Her eyes dropped to the teacup in her hand—the one Vlad had given her earlier. She stared at the pale yellow liquid swirling inside and groaned. "Oh, come on," she muttered, setting the cup down like it was toxic. "Now my imagination's running wild." Without a second thought, she dumped the untouched tea into the sink and turned back with an exaggerated shiver. "Thanks for that. Totally ruined my appetite," she said, feigning indignation before breaking into a grin. "Don't worry, Bill, it's not your fault—it's just how my brain works."

Bill just kept smiling, completely unbothered by the exchange.

Vlad chimed in, "Turns out the settlers on that planet used all that gold to build their own version of Sin City. They call it New Vegas in Space. And now, we're about to see this crazy place for ourselves," he added, a spark of excitement in his voice.

As the ship emerged from hyperspace, Lynn, Bill, and Vlad gazed in awe at the dazzling golden orb known as New Vegas in Space. Its identity was unmistakable, thanks to the colossal sign stretched boldly across its equator, glowing with blinding neon brilliance. Clearly modeled after Earth's famous "Welcome to Fabulous Las Vegas" sign, this version took extravagance to a new level. Towering letters the size of skyscrapers spelled out "Welcome to New Vegas in Space" in a radiant arc, surrounded by endlessly chasing lights and a stylized ring of gleaming stars. Beneath the final letter, a massive retro-futuristic arrow—straight out of a 1950s sci-fi vision—cheerfully pointed toward the planet's only visible spaceport, a flamboyant tower unmistakably shaped like a martini glass.

"I'll be damned," Vlad muttered under his breath.

"No kidding," Bill said, pointing north to where an over-the-top volcano erupted, shooting brilliant streams of liquid gold into the sky.

Lynn stayed silent. For once, she was completely and utterly speechless—a rarity so striking it could have been an event in itself.

The area surrounding them was buzzing with spacecraft of every size and shape imaginable. Tiny scout ships like Vlad's darted about alongside colossal cruise liners that dwarfed everything in their path. Each vessel either aimed for Sin City with unmistakable determination or drifted away, carrying passengers who'd clearly realized their wild escapades had come to an end. With practiced ease, Vlad steered their ship into the incoming stream, joining the

eager crowd headed planet-side. Barely half an hour later, they touched down at the ostentatious spaceport.

When Vlad, Bill, and Lynn disembarked from the spaceship, they were met by a sprightly woman in a black hoodie boldly emblazoned with the words “*SHIT SHOW SUPERVISOR.*” Her silver-blond pixie cut framed a warm, knowing smile that hinted at equal parts wisdom and mischief. With practical glasses perched on her nose and bright red leggings that suggested she had no time for drab interstellar fashion norms, she exuded the kind of seasoned confidence only earned through years of managing chaos, both on and off-world. She welcomed them with a tablet in one hand and an energy that said, “I’ve seen worse, and I’ve got this.”

The woman strode up with an energy that could’ve powered a small ship, practically beaming as she exclaimed, “Vlad! It’s so great to meet you in the flesh finally! You’re like *the* human celebrity out here in the stars. So tell me, how is it that you’ve never stopped by before? Everybody knows about your thing for Vegas, and guess what—we’re *The Vegas*! Everything the original had, but cranked up to eleven! I mean, come on, we’ve got an entire damn planet dedicated to it!”

Vlad was absolutely blindsided by her enthusiasm—completely caught off guard and fumbling for words. While he floundered to pull himself together, she barreled on, diving into a lively rundown of all the over-the-top ways humans and non-humans from across the galaxy could indulge their wildest whims here. She rattled off an endless list of attractions and services,

making it clear this place was always open and ready to fulfill any craving, no matter how outrageous.

Since Vlad was still too dumbstruck to get a single word out, Lynn decided to jump in and take control of the situation. She managed to cut through the woman's cheerful torrent of words, saying, "Hi there, and thanks for the warm welcome! By the way, I'm Lynn, and this is Bill. We're friends of Vlad."

"Of course! So nice to meet both of you!" the woman replied with unrestrained enthusiasm. "Oh man, I totally forgot to introduce myself! That happens when I get overly hyped about our little slice of heaven here, especially meeting someone like Vlad, a literal war hero! Sure, I've met my fair share of celebrities before, but not *this* kind of celebrity!" She paused briefly, as if a thought had suddenly struck her out of nowhere. Then, in a calmer tone, she added, "Wait... I still haven't told you who I am, have I?"

"Nope," Vlad said flatly, starting to shake off his earlier shock and sounding more like himself.

"Right! Let me fix that," she said with a grin. "Name's Sherry—Sherry Moore. The Supreme Ruler of this shiny little jewel personally asked me to drop everything—and trust me, I was juggling a *ton*—to meet you and give you the grand tour around our world."

"Great to meet you, Sherry!" Vlad said warmly. "And thanks for the enthusiastic welcome!"

"Oh, it's nothing, really!" Sherry said with a playful smile, brushing off the thanks. "So, Vlad, what's the plan? Are you sticking with just your charming friends here, Lynn and Bill? Or are you

open to, let's say... enhancing the experience with some of our exceptional entertainers?"

Lynn jumped in quickly, clearly feeling the need to clarify. "Oh no, we're not *together* like that."

"Not an issue at all!" Sherry replied without missing a beat. "That works too! We've got options for everyone—whether you're flying solo or looking for group adventures loaded with variety, you won't find anywhere else! And the best part? Nobody here needs money or any kind of payment. Honestly, we've got more wealth than we know what to do with—we've got all the gold that we need. Actually, we got *ALL* the gold! People live here purely to have fun and share that fun with visitors from across the galaxy. Oh, and it's not just humans around here—we welcome every spacefaring species out there!"

She leaned in slightly, her voice dropping into a tone of eager recommendation. "Now, if you're someone who appreciates the finer things in life—especially when it comes to pleasure—you absolutely have to check out our top-tier specialists. They're known as The Amorpho-Sensual Galactic Order of Interstellar Enticement, Kinetic Yearning, and Orgasmic Synergy—or The Asgoikyos for short. Their motto is legendary: 'Across the stars, we come—so shall you.' Catchy, right?"

Sherry paused dramatically before adding with a mischievous grin, "They've got seven distinct genders—and trust me when I say every single one is equally... let's just call it unforgettable." She leaned in even closer now, lowering her voice as if confiding a thrilling secret. "And yes," she added slyly, "I've sampled them all."

Straightening up with a wink, she continued. “One thing to keep in mind, though—they can shift their gender at will. Sometimes they’ll switch things up on you right in the heat of the moment—keeps things interesting! Oh, and they’re ridiculously strong—stronger than anything you’ve probably ever come across. So if an Asgoikyos decides to make... adjustments during your time together, my advice? Don’t fight it. Just relax and go along for the ‘ride’—it’ll be worth it.”

Vlad shook his head, but before he could get a word in, Sherry chimed in with a grin, “Oh, and don’t forget the classic motto: ‘What happens in Vegas, stays in Vegas.’ When folks leave here, all they take with them are some fond memories, a strong urge to return, and maybe—just maybe—a couple of minor STDs. Nothing significant though, all easily fixable. We’ve only had about three fatal cases per hundred thousand visitors. Those odds? Totally worth the risk if you ask me! And hey, this place is all about taking chances anyway!”

Without pausing for breath, Sherry pressed on, “And trust me, I know what I’m talking about—after all, I’m the Chief Administrator of this planet. It’s literally my job to know everything! So, where do you want to start? How about indulging in a soothing, revitalizing eight-hand massage? The Octembral Touchari from the Sacred Sinew Spiral race—better known simply as the Touchari—deliver massages unlike anything else in the galaxy. Their motto says it all: ‘Why stop at two hands... when eight can take you all the way?’”

Sherry paused, glancing at the group, who stood momentarily stunned, clearly processing everything she’d just unloaded on them.

Breaking the silence, Vlad finally spoke up, “All of that sounds amazing, but before we dive into any of it, we’d really like to meet the Supreme Ruler of this place. We’ve got an invitation.”

Sherry’s eyes lit up with realization as she smacked her forehead lightly. “Oh, right! How could I forget? That tiny little detail slipped my mind—I just got carried away hyping up all the fun stuff! My bad. Don’t worry, I’ll take you there myself!”

Waving them along enthusiastically, Sherry led the crew out onto a sprawling balcony that overlooked the city in all its dazzling glory. The view was nothing short of breathtaking. Below them, the city of New Vegas in Space sprawled out like a treasure trove of lights and sounds. Skyscrapers with reflective surfaces reached for the stars, each building uniquely designed to mimic iconic landmarks from across Earth’s original Vegas strip but enhanced with a futuristic twist.

Sherry leaned on the railing, soaking in their awestruck expressions. “Impressive, huh? This balcony gives you just a taste of what we offer here. It’s like Earth’s Vegas but with so much more—more excitement, more spectacle.”

Lynn couldn’t tear her eyes away from the scene below. “I’ve never seen anything like it,” she admitted.

“And you haven’t even scratched the surface,” Sherry replied with a knowing smile. “This place is designed to overwhelm your senses in the best possible way.”

Bill pointed to a peculiar structure on the horizon. “What is that?” he asked. It was a fiery red building, shaped like something out of a high-octane fever dream. The structure resembled a massive

Formula 1 car standing upright on its tail, with its front wing projecting toward the sky like a proud flagpole. Along one side, the iconic prancing horse emblem gleamed beside bold lettering that read “Forza Ferrari.” At the very tip of the car’s nose—where a racing number would usually be—was a single letter: “V.”

“Oh, that?” Sherry answered with a grin. “That’s where you’re headed—The Supreme Ruler’s Palace.”

The trip to the palace was quick. Lynn, Bill, and Vlad hopped into a red hovercraft that echoed the sleek curves of legendary Italian sports cars—a fitting design, given the palace’s own race-car-inspired architecture. Within minutes of zipping through the air at breakneck speed, they touched down on a landing pad near the pointed apex of the palace. From this vantage point, the view was even more jaw-dropping than before. But Sherry didn’t give them much time to take it all in; she hurried them inside without delay.

As they entered the chamber, Vlad froze in his tracks, momentarily blinded by the golden radiance from a thousand softly glowing pleasure-lights. At the center of the room stood a woman unlike any ruler he’d ever encountered, her figure framed by flowing curtains and a tantalizing aroma that was impossible to place but utterly mesmerizing.

Golden, sunlit waves cascaded over her shoulders, wild and untamed, as if they carried the shimmer of distant constellations. Her grin was broad and devilish, the kind that hinted at secrets both timeless and deliciously inappropriate. With eyes lazily half-closed and sparkling with mischief, she oozed a magnetic mix of authority and playfulness, like a queen who bent empires to her will through sheer charisma.

The Supreme Ruler glided closer, each step deliberate, carrying the sort of poise that could silence wars across entire galaxies. Her voice, smooth as silk and threaded with a touch of Argentinian lilt, flowed effortlessly as she purred, “Hello, Vlad, my name is Veronica... Welcome to New Vegas.”

Veronica faced the group, her eyes settling on Lynn. “Hello, Lynn. I’ve heard so many lovely things about you. It’s great to finally meet you,” she said with a warm smile, offering her hand. Lynn shook it cautiously, her face showing a flicker of confusion. “How do you know about me?” she asked, her brow knitting together.

“All in due time, my dear,” Veronica replied with a soft smile before turning to Bill. “And you must be the famed Stargazer Bill. Your reputation precedes you! It’s truly an honor to have you here.” She reached out and shook Bill’s hand as well, his baffled expression mirroring Lynn’s.

With the introductions out of the way, Veronica stepped back gracefully and purred, “Shall we?” Her arm swept toward the grand double doors on the far side of the room.

Vlad tilted his head, his face marked with curiosity. “Where are we going?”

Veronica’s laughter danced through the air. “Oh, I thought you’d know by now, but if not—well, that makes it all the more intriguing!” she teased, her voice dripping with amusement. Under her breath, almost too low for anyone to hear, she murmured with a sly grin, “Ah, he’s clever. The big man is cunning and persuasive.” But she left them guessing who she might be referring to.

As they approached the towering double doors, Veronica and Sherry moved ahead to open them. Just before their hands touched the handles, Veronica turned around with a mischievous grin. “Alright, everyone, close your eyes! No peeking—trust is everything here!”

“They’re definitely going to sneak a peek anyway,” Sherry said with a smirk that was almost visible in her tone. She crouched down and grabbed a glittering satchel that had been left casually by the door. With an over-the-top flourish, she pulled out a colorful assortment of blindfolds, each one more ridiculous than the last. A pair of playful, pink, fuzzy handcuffs tumbled out of the satchel and landed on the floor. Sherry nudged them aside with her foot, making it pretty clear they weren’t meant to be used—at least not at the moment. Later? Well, that was anyone’s guess.

“Blindfold time, my darlings!” she declared with giddy enthusiasm.

Bill was handed a leopard-print blindfold adorned with fuzzy trim and emblazoned with the phrase “Property of Sherry’s Pleasure Department” in dazzling golden thread.

Vlad received one that read “Touch Me, I’m Famous!” in fluorescent pink letters, complete with a miniature disco ball swinging dramatically from the bridge.

Lynn’s blindfold proudly displayed “I ❤️ Consent” in shimmering sequins, and just underneath it, in tinier and sassier lettering, was written: “(Ask before you grope, sweetie).”

Lynn gave an incredulous snort and gestured toward the remaining options still clutched in Sherry’s hand. “It could be worse,” she remarked dryly. Among the remaining options was one that boldly declared “Insert Here,” complete with an arrow pointing directly down toward the wearer’s nose and other facial features in proximity. Another blinked softly in glow-in-the-dark text: “Mind

Out, Hands In,” while the last bore an embroidered patch that proudly announced: “Junior Spanker – Trainee Level 1.”

By the time everyone had donned their respective blindfolds, the group looked less like adventurers about to embark on a grand mystery and more like contestants in some bizarre, interdimensional kinky game show with questionable, but likely happy endings.

The massive doors creaked open with an air of mystery as Veronica and Sherry gently guided their disoriented companions inside. Then, as if on cue, the magnetic clasps securing the blindfolds released simultaneously and...

“SURPRISE!!!” The thunderous cheer of hundreds of voices rolled through the room like a wave. As Vlad took in the sight before him, it was obvious—the entire G-Nubz colony had shown up! Right at the front of the crowd stood G-Nubz himself, rocking his signature Hawaiian shirt with pride.

“Happy Birthday, Lynn!” he boomed, his deep voice carrying over the commotion, his grin wide and toothy. “Bet you thought we all forgot, huh?” He raised a hand and gestured toward the display behind him. A group of people stood holding sticks, each one topped with a piece of paper that had a single word written on it.

The result? A jumbled message that read: “We, Lynn, All Us Are Overjoyed To Have You Together” with a second group standing on the other side of their leader, “With Happy Love You Birthday,”

G-Nubz threw his hands in the air and bellowed, “What the fuck is this?!” The room erupted into laughter as the group scrambled to rearrange themselves. In no time, they fixed it so the message now proudly said:

“Happy Birthday, Lynn.”

“We Are All Overjoyed To Have You Together With Us.”

“We All Love You.”

Lynn was completely overwhelmed—this was far beyond anything she could have imagined. Tears filled her eyes, but they weren’t from sadness; they were pure, unfiltered joy. As the villagers surrounded her, showering her with warm wishes, she felt something entirely new: a sense of belonging. These weren’t just random people anymore—they were her people.

She turned to Vlad, who stood nearby with Veronica and G-Nubz. Her voice trembled with emotion as she said, "Thank you! Seriously, this is the most amazing gift I could've ever wished for."

Veronica smirked and nodded toward G-Nubz. "Don't thank me—it was all his idea. I just helped pull it together."

Vlad added with a shrug, "Yeah, same here. I didn't even know what was happening. He just told me to get you here, so... mission accomplished."

Veronica clapped her hands and flashed a wide grin. "Alright, everyone, let's get this party started! New Vegas has it all—music, food, drinks, games, massages, and the craziest variety of fun you can imagine. Tonight, it's all yours, free of charge, as always!" With a dramatic snap of her fingers, the bright overhead lights dimmed, giving way to a warm, inviting glow from the ambient lighting spread throughout the room.

And with that, the celebration was officially underway!

A few hours later, Vlad finally tracked down Veronica. There was a question nagging at him, one he couldn't ignore.

"Veronica, can I ask you something?" he said, his voice tinged with curiosity.

"Of course, sweetheart," she replied with a knowing smile. "I think I already know what's on your mind. It's about Nikki, isn't it?"

"Yeah, Nikki. People call her Vegas Nikki, and since we're here in Vegas, I thought you might know her or at least point me in the right direction."

Veronica chuckled softly. "Oh, I know her, all right! Me, Sherry, and Nikki—we built this place from the ground up. That's why everyone calls her Vegas Nikki. With her military and law enforcement background, she was key to making this place safe and stable when we were just starting out." Her expression turned wistful as she added, "But she moved on. I don't know where she is now. She just... packs up and goes wherever the road takes her, chasing whatever it is she's searching for."

Vlad blinked in surprise. "Military? Law enforcement? No way! The Nikki I knew was a showgirl!"

Veronica raised an eyebrow, her expression curious. "Well, sweetie, sounds like we're talking about two completely different Nikkis. If my Nikki ever had anything to do with being a showgirl, she sure kept it a secret from me." She rested a reassuring hand on his shoulder. "Sorry, but it looks like I can't help you with this one."

Vlad gave a small nod, accepting her words without much resistance, as if he hadn't really expected a different outcome. If he was honest with himself, he wasn't even sure why he was so fixated

on finding Nikki anymore. The memories of the showgirl version of Nikki had already started to fade long ago.

It was late morning when Vlad's eyes fluttered open, and he realized he was sprawled on a bed in what could only be described as a pleasure-party room.

"Some party," he muttered under his breath, his eyelids heavy like an Abrams tank and his head pounding like a church bell on Sunday morning. Groggily, he scanned the room and noticed a carafe with a tag that read: "Wakeup Juice – Strictly for Morning Use." Inside, a liquid shimmered, reflecting every color of the rainbow and blinking as if it were alive. Shaking away some of the fog in his mind, Vlad sighed in relief—the dazzling colors weren't from some strange drink but from the glittery party hat still perched crookedly on his head.

Without hesitation, he downed the contents of the carafe in a few swift gulps. Almost immediately, the pounding in his head disappeared, and flashes of the previous night came rushing back. A sly grin spread across his face as the memories unfolded. Oh, what a night it had been.

Ignoring Sherrie's cautious warnings, Vlad had decided to flirt with danger—or more specifically, with an irresistibly captivating Asgoikyos. The romance took off like a poorly piloted rocket, spiraling out of control. Just as Sherrie had predicted, things took a sudden, genre-bending twist when the Asgoikyos, mid-passion, shifted from version 3 to version 7—flipping the script, reversing the roles, and quite literally seizing control standing behind his backside. One moment, Vlad was leading the dance; the next, the music changed, and he realized he was about to become the playtoy of the powerful seducer.

But Vlad wasn't one to be outmaneuvered. He flat-out refused to play by their rules, putting an end to their little trickery. Granted, the way he resolved the trouble lacked a certain amount of dignity. Fleeing across the ballroom completely naked while a towering Asgoikyos chased after him, enthusiastically scattering pheromones everywhere, had been both mortifying and wildly amusing for everyone else watching.

With these memories fresh on his mind, Vlad pulled himself to his feet and surveyed the scene. The room was silent and deserted, with the door not just locked but barricaded by an impressive heap of furniture he'd frantically stacked there earlier. You could never be too cautious when dealing with an aroused Asgoikyos—especially one with an unparalleled *penetrating power*.

Scouting the space for anything wearable proved fruitless. Not a single article of clothing in sight, leaving him with nothing but the absurdly festive party hat on his head, still winking its multicolored lights like it had no idea how ridiculous it looked. With a resigned shrug, Vlad snatched a bedsheet off the nearest bed and fashioned it into a crudely improvised toga. Satisfied enough with his new 'ensemble,' he dismantled the pile blocking the door, unlatched the lock, and cracked it open just enough to peek out. His eyes darted up and down the hallway. Not an Asgoikyos in sight. In fact, the whole corridor was eerily empty.

Deeming it safe, he stepped out cautiously and began wandering through the sprawling pleasure palace. The aftermath of last night's debauchery was everywhere—clothing discarded across the floor, overturned chairs, and partygoers passed out in various

states of undress. Some snored peacefully alone, while others were intertwined in pairs—or, in several instances, sprawled in massive cuddle piles that could rival professional rugby scrums.

As Vlad passed one of the many rooms with its door slightly open, a flicker of movement caught his eye. Unable to resist his curiosity, he glanced inside. On a velvety red bed, Lynn lay curled on her side, facing the door. Her eyes were closed, and she was nestled comfortably in the arms of a man cuddled behind her.

The man Vlad never met before. He was a strong-built human, with arms that looked powerful enough to twist rebars into decorative spirals. His beard was a wild, proud copse—dark and full, like a mountain hermit who'd made peace with the forest long ago. A battered ball cap clung to his head like it had survived hurricanes with him, and his skin had the kind of deep tan you earn from a life outdoors, not a weekend at the beach. Even asleep, he looked content—calm in the way only a man who'd walked through fire and come out clean can be. The unbuttoned Hawaiian shirt he wore was a loud contradiction: ocean-blue and covered in vibrant flowers, it displayed the grinning face of another bold, familiar-looking man right across the chest, giving the whole outfit a surreal, almost cult-leader vibe.

Vlad blinked, studying the guy moving behind Lynn. Whoever this man was, he looked like he could wrestle a moose, build a log cabin, fistfight a bear, and then apologize for scaring it. But that shirt—it looked familiar. Vlad muttered under his breath, “Wait a second... isn't that the same shirt G-Nubz was wearing last night?

How did this guy end up with it? And do I even want to track down BigG to hear the story behind that?"

His voice must've carried because all the movements stopped, Lynn stirred and cracked her eyes open, her cheerful grin still firmly in place like she'd been dreaming about sunshine and puppies. "Oh hey," she said brightly. "Nice toga." Vlad pushed the door open wider and stepped inside. He nodded in acknowledgment. "Thanks! So... how was the party? Did you have fun?"

Lynn's grin stretched into something almost playful. "Why stop at 'was'? I was still having fun just a moment ago!"

Right then, the guy next to her groaned, his face twisting as he shot Vlad a look that practically said *seriously?*. Before the silence could turn awkward, Lynn jumped in. "Oh! Vlad, this is my husband, Shane." She waved toward the rugged man beside her as if she were presenting one of the most important men in her life. "Shane and I met last night and decided to get hitched at one of those self-checkout marriage booths here. They're super efficient! Oh-oh! And they've got self-checkout divorce booths too! Not that we'll ever need one, right, my love?"

Shane grumbled something unintelligible—more a primal growl than actual words, his annoyance clear at being interrupted at such a delicate moment.

"Congrats!" Vlad beamed, genuinely surprised but happy for her nonetheless. "That's awesome news! Happy birthday again, Lynn."

He gave a small wave before stepping back out of the room. As he reached to close the door, Lynn called out with unusual warmth,

“Vlad! Don’t lose hope—happiness is out there waiting for you too! You’ll find it when you least expect it.” Her smile shifted to something more genuine. “And thanks for this trip—it’s been incredible.”

With a small nod, Vlad gently closed the door and resumed his walk down the long hallway. Despite the chaos and surprises, he felt content knowing his friend was happy. Deep down, he believed that someday his own bit of happiness would find its way into his life too—probably dressed in something just as absurd as that Hawaiian shirt.